

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.8. 21st of April 2025



NO SWEET CANE WITH MONEY The missing ingredient in offerings

Isaiah 43:24 *You have not bought me sweet cane with money or satisfied me with the fat of your sacrifices. But you have burdened me with your sins; you have wearied me with your iniquities. ESV*

Isaiah 43:24 *You did not buy me any sugar cane with your money or satisfy me with the best part of your sacrifices. Rather, you burdened me with your sins and troubled me with your wrongdoings. God's Word*

You have not bought me any sweet cane

Previously I wrote some thoughts on this subject but here are some additional ones that come to my mind as to its relevance and importance for us as believers today.

This particular phrase *"you have brought me no sweet cane"* still captivates my attention as to the significance of its presence in any offering we make to God.

God's displeasure

The verse clearly states of God's displeasure at the manner/attitude in which his people were making their offerings to him.

"You have not bought me sweet cane with money":

"Nor have you satisfied me with the fat of your sacrifices":

The missing ingredient

It was the absence of the most important element in worship.

There was no sweet cane or fat In the people's offerings and worship to God.

- This meant that the people had not offered sacrifices out of a **genuine desire to please** God, but rather as a superficial gesture.

"You have burdened me with your sins":

"You have wearied me with your iniquities"

- This underscores the destructive nature of their sins, which had exhausted and worn-down God's patience and love for them.

God was looking for the missing ingredients

Sincerity and genuineness to please him by acknowledgement of their sinful lifestyle and their lack of repentance and humility before him regardless of their offerings and sacrifices

There was:

"No Sweet Cane" For God

Isaiah 43:24 You have not bought me sweet cane with money or satisfied me with the fat of your sacrifices. But you have burdened me with your sins; you have wearied me with your iniquities. ESV

Sweet cane.

In ancient times, sweet cane was a fragrant plant used in making incense, and **it was often offered as a symbol of worship and honor to God.**

By NOT bringing **sweet cane with money**, the Israelites **failed to give God the reverence and adoration** he deserved.

Sweet cane

According to Jeremiah, this expensive delicacy came from "a far country"

Jeremiah 6:20 What do I care about incense from Sheba or sweet calamus from a distant land? Your burnt offerings are not acceptable; your sacrifices do not please me." NIV

Sweet cane was one of the ingredients that God instructed Moses to use in the formula for the holy anointing oil - Exodus 30:23 and it was used in the sanctuary to produce a sweet-smelling sacrifice.

Exodus 30:23 "Take the finest spices: twelve pounds of liquid myrrh, half that amount (that is, six pounds) of sweet-smelling cinnamon, six pounds of sweet-smelling cane, NCV

And those who brought **sweet cane** were expressing their **sincere worship and reverence** for God.

This message is something that we all need to be reminded of today.

We need to supply the missing ingredients essential for offerings and worship made to our Lord.

Significance of Sweet sugar-cane

Firstly, it represents devout individuals who are characterized by their sweet disposition, embodying kindness and spirituality.

Sweet cane refers to the fragrant calamus used in preparing the holy oil which was an offering presented to God. The people had not brought this or other sacrifices to appease God.

The people had not offered sacrifices out of a genuine desire to please God but rather as a superficial gesture.

Without money

The lack of money here doesn't refer to a lack of wealth. Instead, it highlights the lack of genuine dedication and devotion behind the Israelites' offerings. They were buying the sweet cane, but their hearts were not truly seeking to appease God.

In Isaiah 43:24, "with money" refers to **the cost** of offerings, specifically "sweet cane" and "fat of your sacrifices." it emphasizes that there was a **COST** involved in these offerings made to God.

The verse is God rebuking his people for failing to genuinely honor Him, even with the outward act of offering costly sacrifices.

God is saying that their material offerings, even though purchased with money, were not sufficient without a genuine heart of repentance and obedience.

THE FAT

The **fat** referred to here is symbolic of **the best part** of the sacrifice being made and **the fat of the inner organs of the sacrifice is God's portion**

and is forbidden for man to eat it.

Leviticus 7:25 Anyone who eats the fat of an animal from which an offering by fire may be made to the Lord must be cut off from his people. NIV

The fat was the best part of an animal offering and had to be burned completely as **a gift** to Yahweh.

The application to Christians today is that we must give to our Creator the best we have to offer, and that includes our time, energy, and worship.

The Biblical meaning of **fat** (Hebrew word = "heleb") signifies the richest part of the animal, or the fattest of the flock, Easton's Bible Dictionary

GOD'S HEART IS REVEALED

In the way the scripture is written— *"You have not bought me sweet cane with money or satisfied me with the fat of your sacrifices"*, reveals the cry of God's heart and his longing for those missing elements, **the sweet cane and the fat** and what they represented.

GOD LONGED to see the **sweetness** of genuine **repentance, obedience** and **reverence** to their God in their offerings.

HIS HEART ACHED for the **Sweet cane** and **the choicest part (the fat)** that symbolized the **SWEETNESS OF HUMILITY** AND **REVERENCE** that his people should be offering to him.

IT WAS THE **ABSENCE** OF THESE ELEMENTS THAT DISAPPOINTED HIM.

HE MISSED from his people

- The **SWEETNESS of HUMILITY** that expresses itself in a passionate desire to **FOLLOW** and **PLEASE** God.
- The **SWEETNESS and PEASANTNESS of OBEDIENCE**.
- The **SWEETNESS of SUBMISSION** and **HONOUR**.
- The **SWEETNESS of a SOFT HEART** before God.
- He longed for the **SWEETNESS OF AUTHENTIC WORSHIP AND DEVOTION TO HIM**.
- THESE WERE **THE ELEMENTS** THAT HE DESIRED HIS PEOPLE TO POSSESS WHEN MAKING THEIR OFFERINGS TO HIM.

WHAT ABOUT US?

- SURELY OUR LORD GOD WOULD ALSO DESIRE FROM US **THOSE ELEMENTS OF SWEETNESS** THAT MAKES **HIS HEART PLEASED**.
- THIS PASSAGE OF ISAIAH 34:24 CARRIES A TIMELESS MESSAGE THAT RESONATES WITH TODAY'S BELIEVERS, urging us to be certain that in offerings are filled with the presence of **the SWEET CANE OF HUMILITY, REPENTANCE, SUBMISSION, WORSHIP AND REVERENCE TO GOD**.

Amen - Ps Barry